Helix Technologies - Performance Review & Promotion Policy

Document ID: HR-008
Version: 2026.1
Effective date: January 1, 2026
Owner: People Operations

1. Purpose

This policy describes how Helix Technologies evaluates employee performance and how promotion and compensation decisions are made. It applies to all regular full-time and part-time employees.

2. Review Cycle

Helix runs a formal performance review twice per year. The primary review takes place in the spring (March-April) and a lighter mid-year check-in takes place in the fall (September-October).

Compensation changes and promotions resulting from the primary spring review take effect on July 1.

3. How Performance Is Assessed

Reviews assess two dimensions: **what** an employee delivered against their goals and **how** they worked, measured against the Helix values described in the Employee Handbook (HR-001).

Each employee writes a self-review, requests peer feedback from at least three colleagues and receives a written review and rating from their manager.

4. Rating Scale

Rating	Meaning
1 - Below expectations	Performance is not meeting the role's requirements; a performance improvement plan may follow.
2 - Meets some expectations	Partially meeting expectations; specific development areas identified.
3 - Meets expectations	Consistently delivering the responsibilities of the role.
4 - Exceeds expectations	Regularly delivering beyond the role's expectations.
5 - Outstanding	Exceptional impact well beyond the role.

5. Promotions

Promotions recognize sustained performance at the next level, not just strong performance in the current role. A promotion requires a written case from the manager, endorsement from a peer manager and approval from the department director.

Promotion decisions are made during the spring review cycle. Off-cycle promotions are possible in exceptional cases with director and People Operations approval.

6. Compensation Changes

Merit increases are tied to the performance rating and the employee's position in their pay band. The annual merit budget is set by Finance each year.

Equity refresh grants may be awarded to high performers during the spring cycle and vest over four years (see Benefits & Compensation, HR-004).

7. Performance Improvement Plans

An employee rated **Below expectations** may be placed on a performance improvement plan (PIP) of 30 to 60 days with clear, measurable goals and regular check-ins. People Operations supports the manager throughout the PIP.

8. Contact

Questions about performance reviews or promotions should go to People Operations at people@helixtech.example.